Second Meeting of the *Global Technical Working Group on WHO Road Safety Legal Guidance*

1 October 2026, 13:30 CEST, virtual format (via MS Teams)

1. Agenda

Topic	Presenter
Welcome and update	WHO (Dr. Fangfang Luo)
Presentation of scoping reviews: (1) distracted driving, (2) speed and infrastructure, and (3) powered two-wheelers safety	The George Institute
Q&A	All participants
Wrap up and next steps	WHO (Dr. Fangfang Luo)

2. Welcome and update (Fangfang Luo, WHO)

- Dr Luo opened the meeting, thanked members for reviewing the evidence-synthesis protocols and draft questionnaire, and noted that the work is now at the evidence-gathering stage.
- She presented the large-scale consultation questionnaire, which complements the evidence synthesis by capturing country views and practical experience. It targets government policymakers, legislators and partners.
- The questionnaire has four sections: institutional information; distracted driving; speed management and infrastructure; and powered two- and three-wheelers. The link will be shared with members the following week.
- Dissemination will run from around October to early December 2026 through regional events and WHO regional offices, targeting about 70–80 mostly low- and middle-income countries.

Questions and comments on the questionnaire

- It was noted that the questionnaire's data elements are already part of some regional data collection, and that responses may be submitted on behalf of countries in those regions.
- Members asked whether the questionnaire would reach road and infrastructure agencies directly; WHO confirmed it seeks the widest possible reach, including transport ministries, and welcomed recommendations on national contacts.
- Members noted that one respondent may not be able to answer every section for their country; WHO explained that respondents can indicate whether they answer personally or officially, complete sections separately, and skip questions outside their expertise.

3. Scoping review findings (The George Institute)

Methodology (Jagnoor Jagnoor, George Institute)

- Dr Jagnoor presented the methodology. The review sought effective policy and legislative approaches, considering design for effectiveness, enforcement, and equity and the safe system approach.

- It covered legislative, regulatory and policy interventions in peer-reviewed and grey literature, including sources in Arabic, Spanish, Portuguese and Mandarin; behavioural studies without policy relevance were excluded.
- She noted that the infrastructure search terms are being revised and that a short summary per domain will be shared with members.

Distracted driving (Medhavi Gupta, George Institute)

- 91 sources were included, mostly from high-income countries and focused on mobile phone laws; evidence on law development, governance and the private sector's role was limited.
- Effective laws use clear, technology-neutral definitions, universal coverage, primary-offence status, graduated penalties, public education and scheduled review.
- Effective enforcement requires targeted detection (e.g. automated cameras), sustained visibility, adequate capacity and coordination from detection to sanction, supported by standardised data and monitoring.
- Equity and safe system principles were rarely addressed (three sources on equity; 21% engaging with safe system thinking).

Speed management and infrastructure (Jagnoor Jagnoor, George Institute)

- 76 sources were included, mostly from China and the United States; equity was considered in 29% and safe system principles in 20%.
- Effective laws set limits that protect people (no more than 50 km/h in urban areas; 30 km/h where vehicles mix with vulnerable road users), based on road function and injury tolerance and aligned with road design.
- Effective enforcement depends on enabling laws for devices and liability, credible graduated sanctions, public legitimacy, capable lead agencies, and data that feeds back into review of the law.
- Safe system principles and protections for vulnerable road users appear mostly in technical guidance rather than binding legal duties.

Powered two- and three-wheelers (Dennis Mazingi, George Institute)

- Motorcycle numbers more than tripled globally between 2011 and 2025, and new vehicle types and delivery platforms can quickly make laws outdated.
- 144 sources were included, concentrated on helmet legislation; Africa and South America were underrepresented, and evidence on roads, speed and whole-system approaches was a major gap.
- Effective laws need clear definitions that keep pace with new vehicles, universal coverage rather than exemptions, requirements matched to risk, and shared legal responsibility across governments, manufacturers and commercial operators.
- Compliance costs fall disproportionately on low-income users, and responsibility still centres on the rider; the key message was that system responsibility should become legal responsibility.

Cross-cutting findings (Jagnoor Jagnoor, George Institute)

- Recurring themes across the three reviews were clear definitions, implementable laws, credible enforcement, shared responsibility, and ongoing monitoring and evaluation.
- Blind spots include unclear causality, little evidence on implementation, limited evaluation of duties beyond road users, rarely measured equity, and underrepresentation of LMICs.

4. Discussion — key points raised

Members raised the following points during discussion:

- Allow members to submit additional sources and detailed written feedback on the full reports;
- Include congestion and demand management as drivers of motorcycle growth;
- Separate general good practice in behaviour-based regulation from evidence specific to each topic, noting that most evidence is associative rather than causal;
- Do not treat the existence of a law as evidence of its effectiveness, as many laws are not evidence-based;
- Examine distracted driving among commercial operators and organisational liability;
- Unpack equity among motorcyclists, including the wider social costs of motorcycle use;
- Address identification of vehicles and riders as a key enforcement challenge;
- Produce a two-page policy brief to support advocacy in countries;
- Acknowledge two-wheeler classes outside the regulatory remit (e.g. low-power and electric two-wheelers);
- Base speed-limit setting in law on the road's functional use rather than its classification;
- Review fiscal incentives for motorcycles (e.g. tax breaks in Brazil and Colombia) and the resulting health-system burden;
- Consider policies supporting safer, sustainable modes (e.g. cycling networks, public transport) that reduce exposure; and
- Distinguish urban street design from highway practice in policy recommendations.

The George Institute and WHO Secretariat welcomed these points and agreed to consider them in finalising the reports. WHO outlined emerging directions: expanding distracted driving beyond road-user behaviour; translating speed and infrastructure guidance into legally binding obligations; and a comprehensive legal framework align to safe system for powered two- and three-wheelers.

The George Institute noted that some gaps may reflect the absence of laws rather than of evaluations, which the questionnaire should help clarify.

5. Next steps

- The George Institute and the GTWG will finalise the three scoping review reports in October–November 2026; summaries will be shared with members for comment.
- The questionnaire consultation will run from October to early December 2026, with analysis in December, followed by key informant interviews with policymakers and partners.
- The third GTWG meeting is planned for January 2027 to present the combined results.

6. Attendance

Members

1. **Dr. Rania Hamada Saad Abdelhamid** — Technical Officer, WHO Regional Office for the Eastern Mediterranean (EMR)
2. **Ms. Claudia Adriazola-Steil** — Director, Health and Road Safety – Deputy Global Director, Transport, World Resources Institute (WRI)
3. **Staff Lieutenant Colonel Saif Ahmed Mohammed Al Ramadhani** — Director of Executive Office of the National Committee for Road Safety (NCRS), Royal Oman Police
4. **Mr. Dipan Bose** — Senior Transport Specialist and Global Lead for Road Safety, World Bank
5. **Mr. Ignacio Ibarra** — Advisor (Legal), WHO Regional Office for the Americas (AMR) / PAHO
6. **Ms. Marisela Ponce de Leon Valdes** — Road Safety Pillar Lead – Senior Transport Specialist, SSATP, World Bank
7. **Ms. Binta Sako** — Technical Officer, WHO Regional Office for Africa (AFR)
8. **Mr. David Shelton** — Manager, Global Road Safety Advocacy and Grants Programme, GRSP
9. **Mr. Abu-Bakr Sheriff** — Secretary to the Authority and Board, Sierra Leone Road Safety Authority (SLRSA)
10. **Dr. Johan Strandroth** — Director, Strandroth Inc.
11. **Dr. Tashi Tobgay** — Technical Officer, WHO Regional Office for South-East Asia (SEAR)
12. **Dr. Xuesong Wang** — Professor, Tongji University
13. **Prof. Dr. Wong Shaw Voon** — Professor; Chairman of the Board of Directors, Universiti Putra Malaysia; Malaysian Institute of Road Safety Research (MIROS)
14. **Ms. Xi Yin** — Coordinator, WHO Regional Office for the Western Pacific (WPR)

Observers

1. **Eng. Mooath Aldossari** — Director General of Strategic Management, Planning and Data, Ministerial Committee for Traffic Safety, Saudi Arabia
2. **Ms. Becky Bavinger** — Bloomberg Philanthropies
3. **Ms. Jazmín Contreras Luna** — on behalf of the Director of FONAT, El Salvador
4. **Mr. Francois Guichard** — Mechanical Engineer; Secretary to WP.29/GRVA, WP.1 and the WP.29 IWG on ITS, United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE)
5. **Dr. Medhavi Gupta** — The George Institute for Global Health
6. **Mr. Yeasir Inzzamam Iftekhar** — Consultant, WHO Regional Office for the Western Pacific (WPR)
7. **Dr. Jagnoor Jagnoor** — Associate Professor, The George Institute for Global Health
8. **Dr. Dennis Mazingi** — The George Institute for Global Health
9. **Ms. Lievanta Millar** — Bloomberg Philanthropies
10. **Mr. Luiz Otavio Maciel Miranda** — Technical Assistant, Traffic Department of the State of Pará (DETRAN/PA), Brazil
11. **Dr. Sara Mohammed** — Technical Officer, WHO Regional Office for the Eastern Mediterranean (EMR)
12. **Mr. Renan Monteiro Carioca** — Research Manager, Global Designing Cities Initiative (GDCI)
13. **Mr. Eduardo Pompeo** — Global Designing Cities Initiative (GDCI)
14. **Dr. Maria Segui-Gomez** — Professor, Universidad Pontificia Comillas

WHO Secretariat

1. **Dr. Matts-Ake Belin** — Technical Officer and Global Lead of the Decade of Action for Road Safety, DPP, WHO HQ
2. **Mr. Daniel Hougendobler** — Technical Officer (Legal), DPP, WHO HQ
3. **Mr. Kacem Iaych** — Technical Officer, DPP, WHO HQ
4. **Dr. Fangfang Luo** — Technical Officer (Legal), DPP, WHO HQ
5. **Dr. Nhan Tran** — Unit Head, DPP, WHO HQ